Nice to meet you, Business Analaysts!

Career Capital for BAs

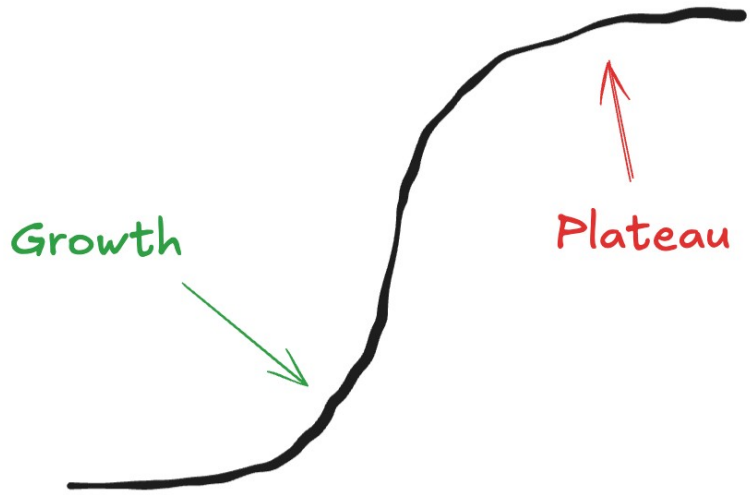
How to Become So Good They Can’t Ignore You

Trevin Nimaladasa

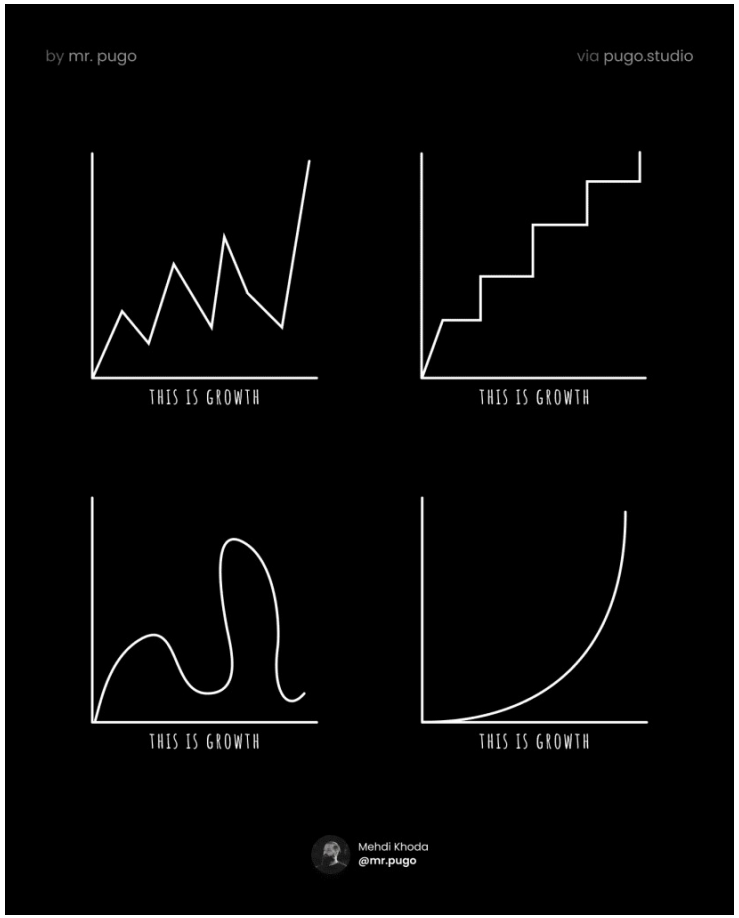
October-2025

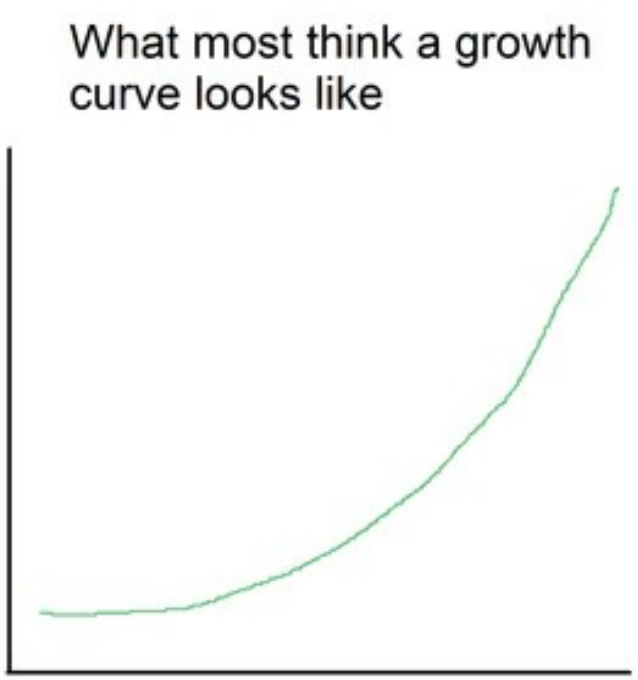
Why Do Some BAs Grow While Others Plateau?

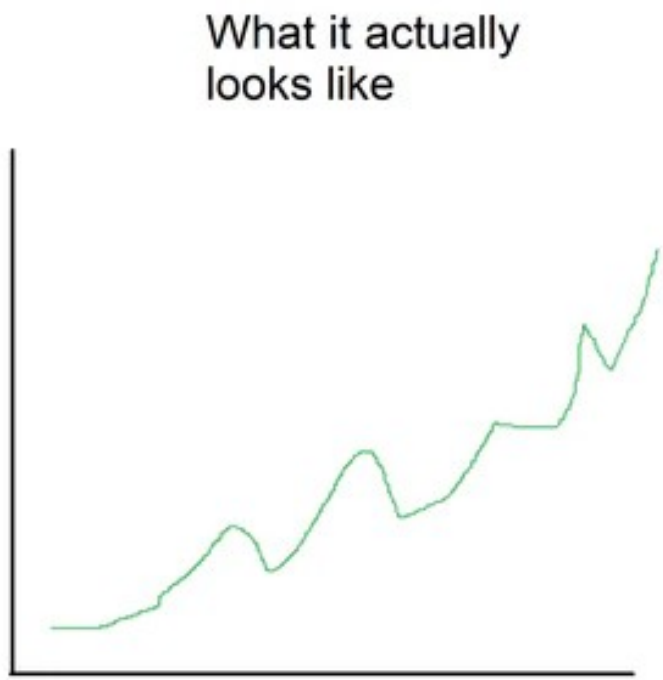
Growth vs Plateau



What Growth Looks like

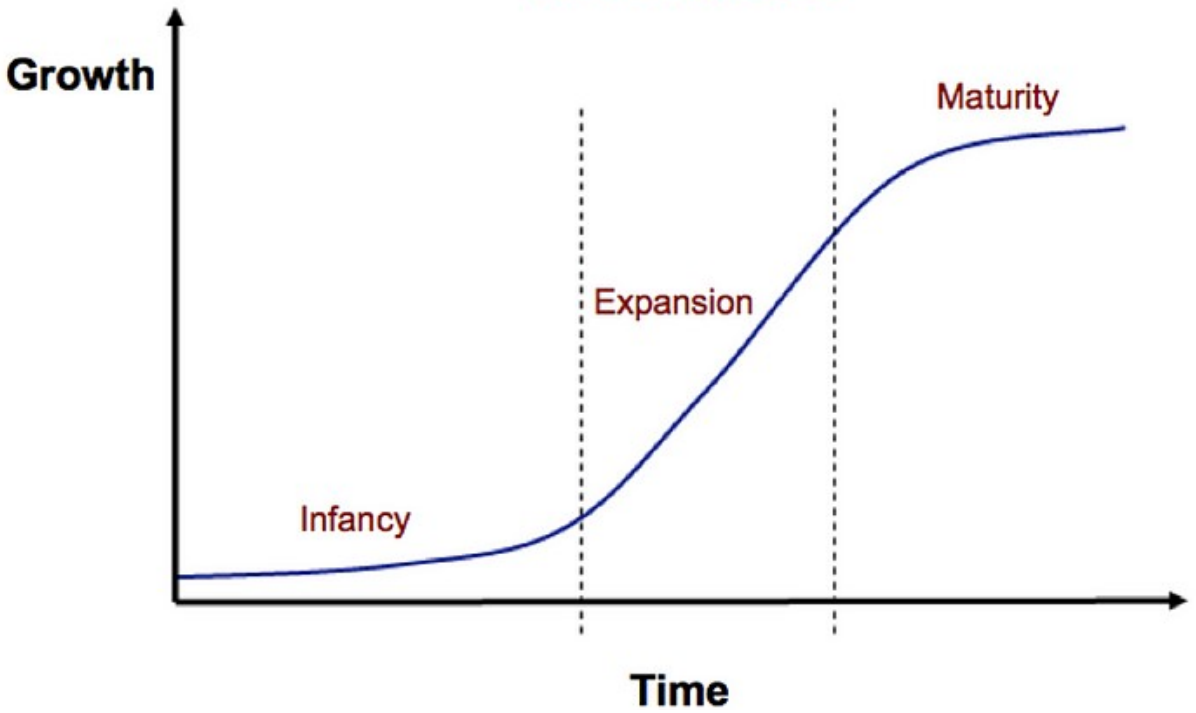




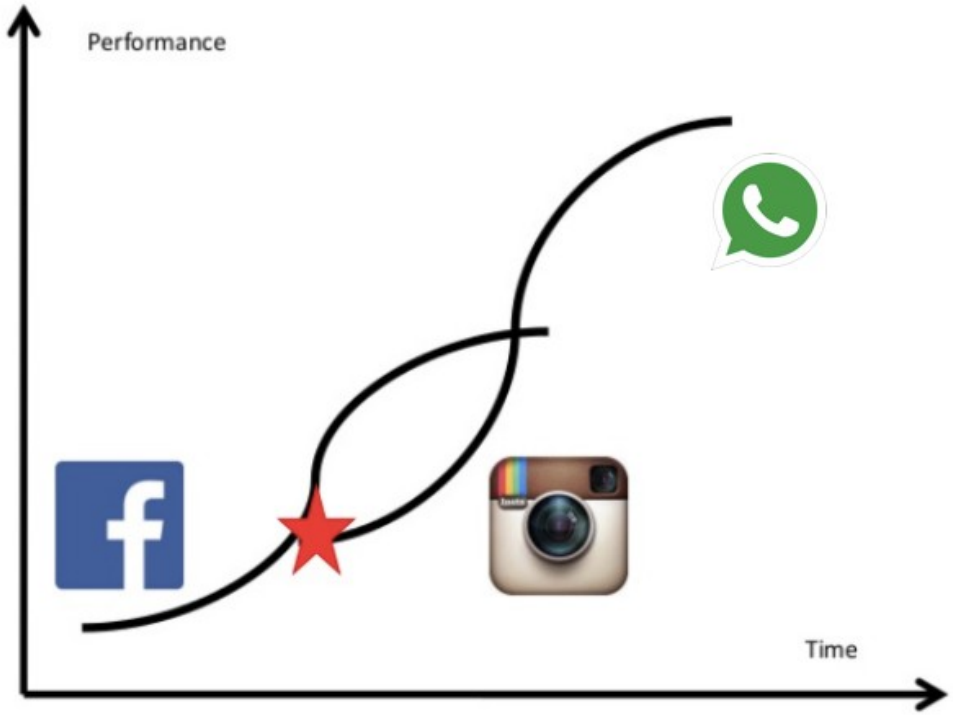


S Curve

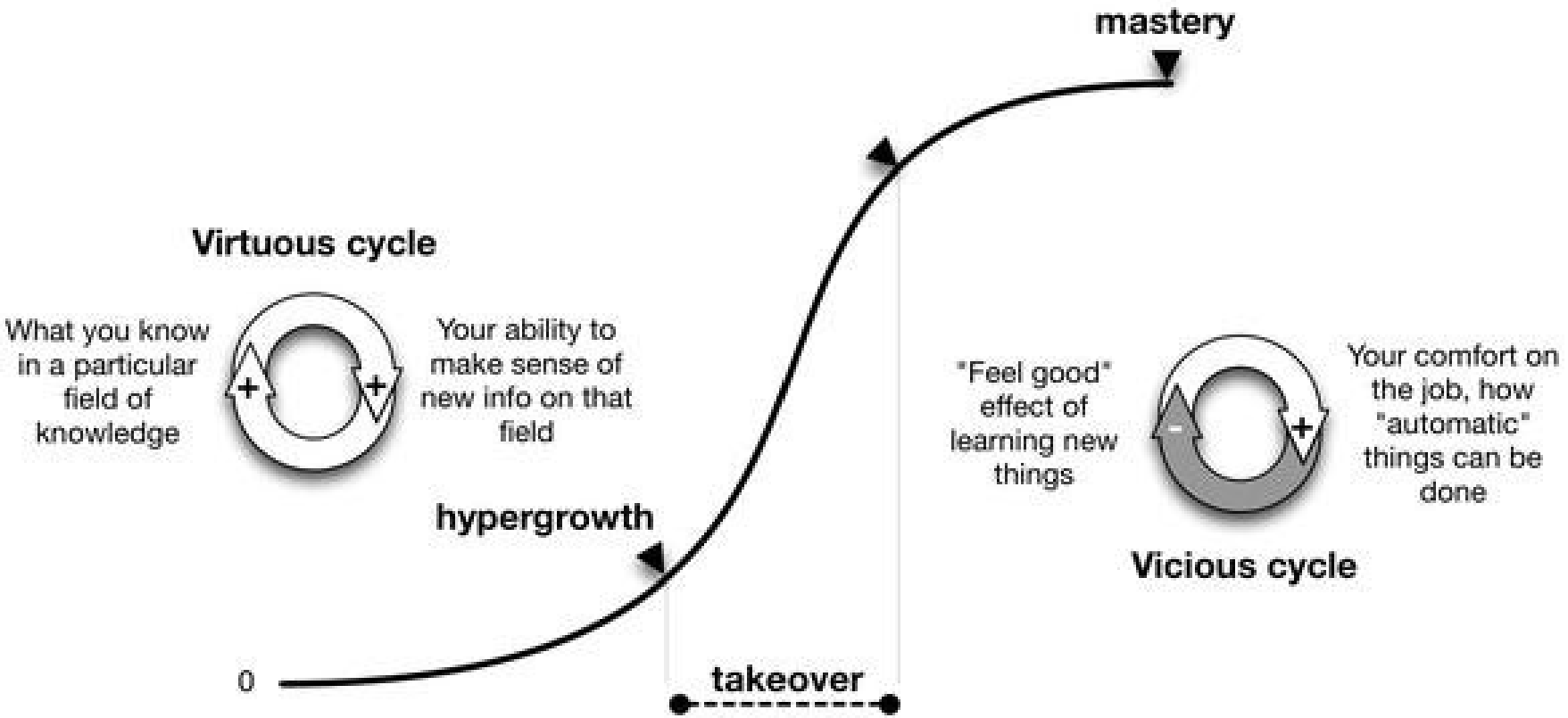
Business Life Cycle



Facebook's S-Curve



Applying S curves to your career path



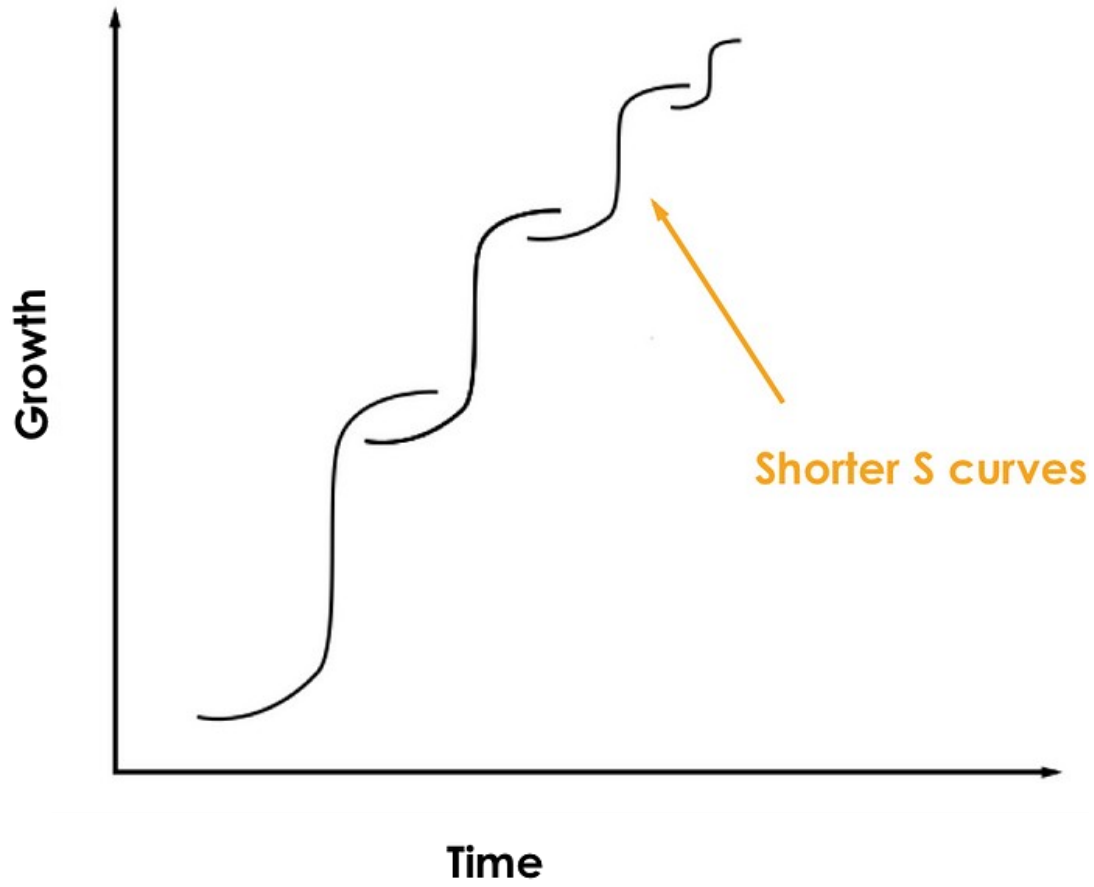
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Applying S curves to your career path



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Shorter career S curves in the future



What is Career Capital?

- Beyond Skills: Building Value That Compounds
- The Currency of Career Growth
- The Real Reason People Get Noticed

Career Capital

the skills, knowledge, experiences, and connections you accumulate over time that make you valuable in the workplace and give you leverage in shaping your career.

It's what allows you to access better roles, negotiate flexibility, and create fulfilling work on your terms.





The **skills you have** that are **both rare and valuable** and that **can be used as leverage** in defining your career

The 3 type of Career Capital

Skills Capital



Rare and valuable skills that make you indispensable in your field.

↓

Acquired through deliberate practice and deep work.

↓

This is the core focus - developing craftsman-like excellence.

Social Capital



Connections, networks, and relationships that open doors.

↓

Includes mentors, influential peers, and professional communities.

↓

Useful for opportunities, collaboration, and visibility.

Reputation Capital



Your personal brand and credibility in your domain.

↓

Built through consistent delivery, thought leadership, and public recognition.

↓

Includes testimonials, published work, speaking engagements, etc.

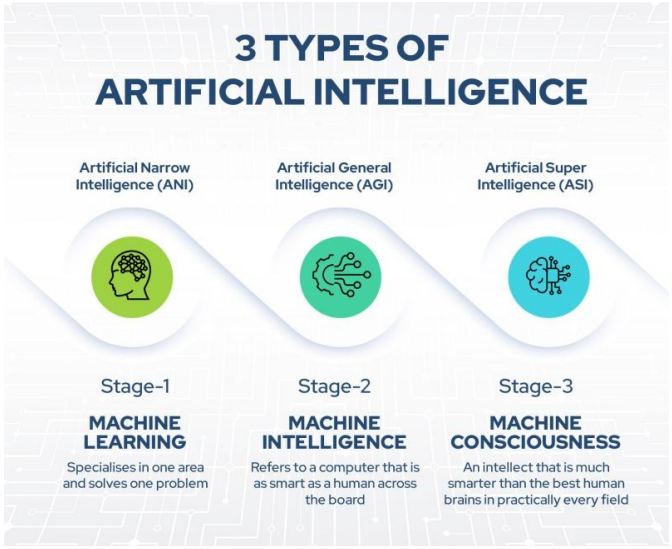
Why BAs Need Career Capital Now

The World of Work has Changed – Have You?

- The Modern BA Challenge
- Uncertainty Demands Intentional Growth
- Evolve or Get Left Behind

The Modern BA Challenge

Roles are evolving, ***FAST!***







AI is reshaping decision-making and delivery

Agile and product models demand versatility

Flatter orgs = less hand-holding, more ownership.

Career Paths Are No Longer Linear

Uncertainty Demands Intentional Growth



Career ladders are disappearing

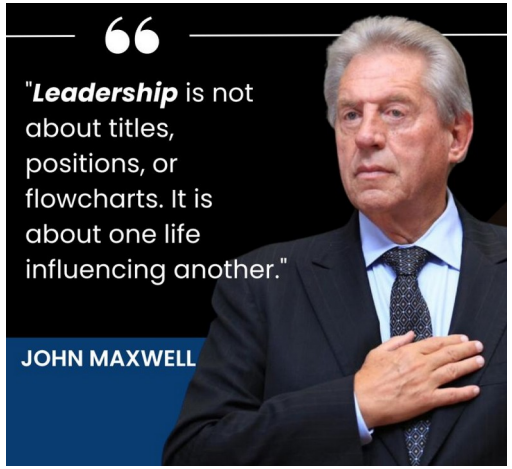


Job security = skill security



Progression now depends on value, not tenure.

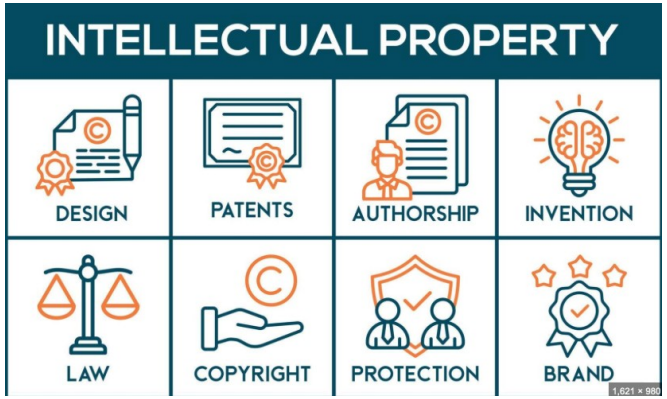
You Need Assets That Speak Louder Than Titles *Evolve or Get Left Behind*



Titles don’t guarantee trust or opportunity.



Career capital = your edge in a competitive market



Build rare & valuable assets to stay relevant

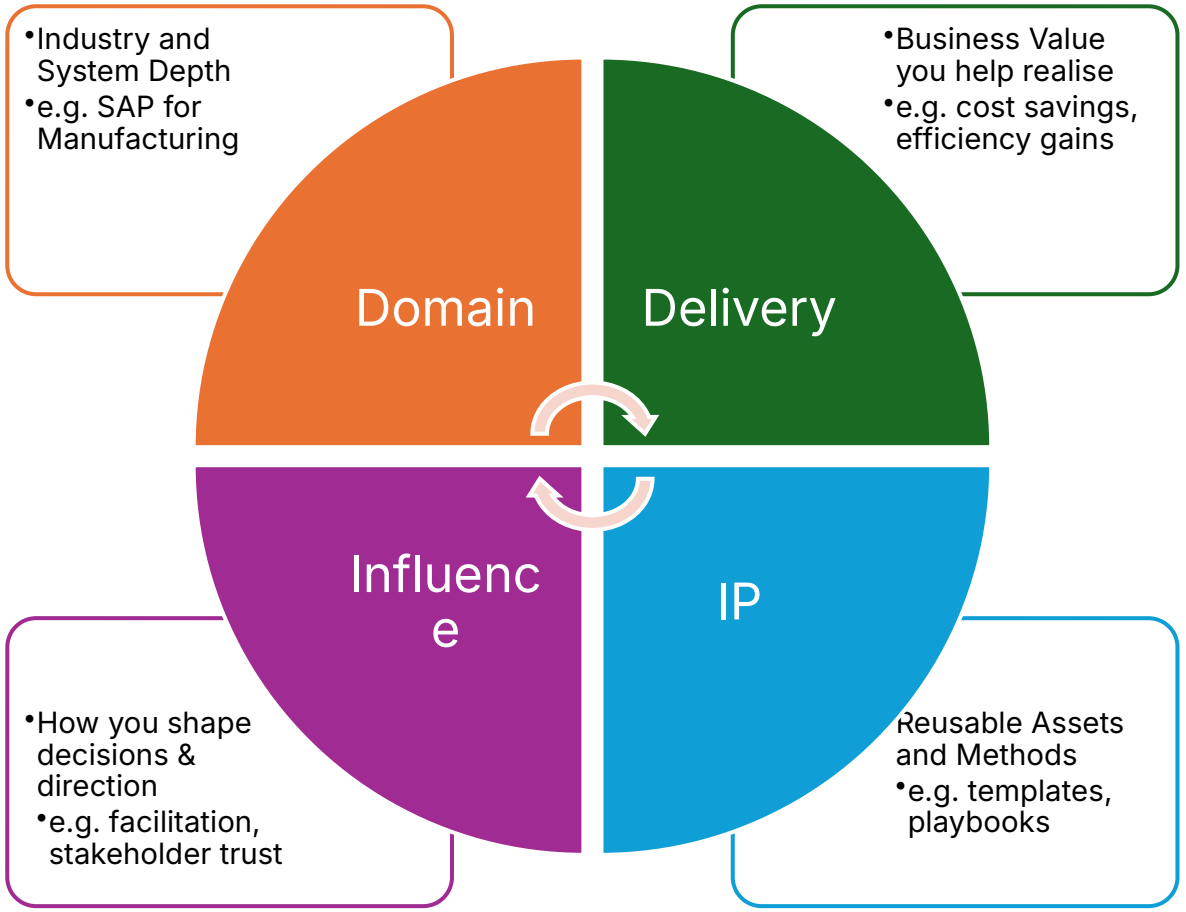
The 4 Types of Career Capital for BAs

Build These, and Opportunities Will Follow

A Balanced Portfolio for BA Success

Where Are You Investing Your Energy?

The 4 Types of Career Capital for BAs



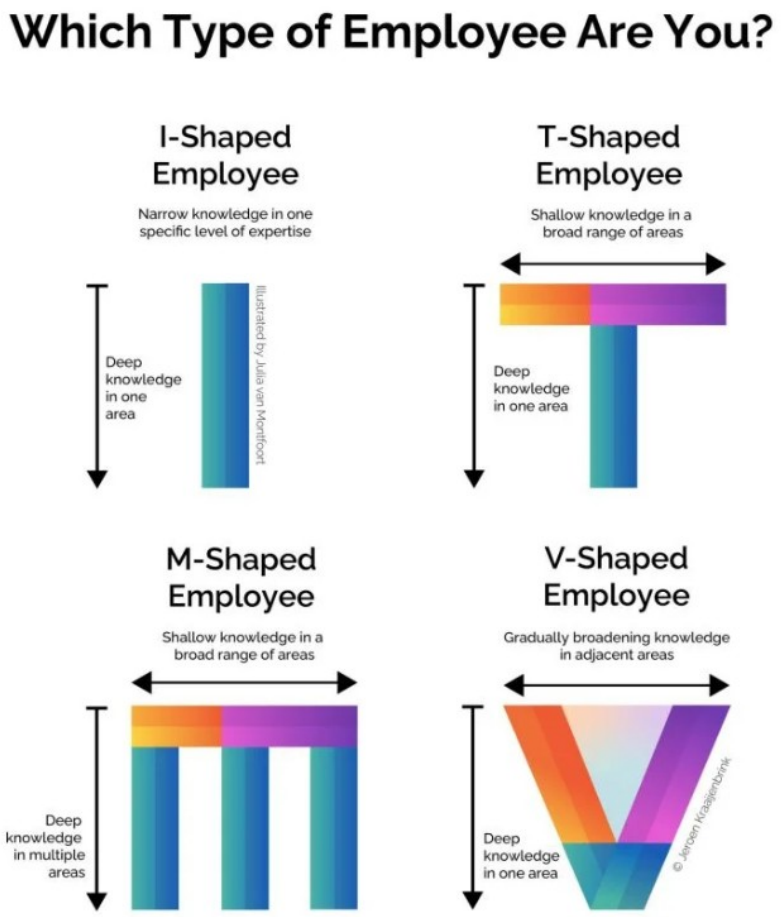
Domain Capital

- The Power of Focus
- Owning Your Niche
- Depth Creates Value

Domain Capital

depth that sets you *apart*

- ✓ **Expertise in a domain, business function, or system** *(e.g. Finance, Utilities, ERP, CRM)*
- ✓ **Specialisation** = differentiation in a crowded market
- ✓ **Ask yourself:** *What domain do you own?*



Resource: GWFM Research & Study

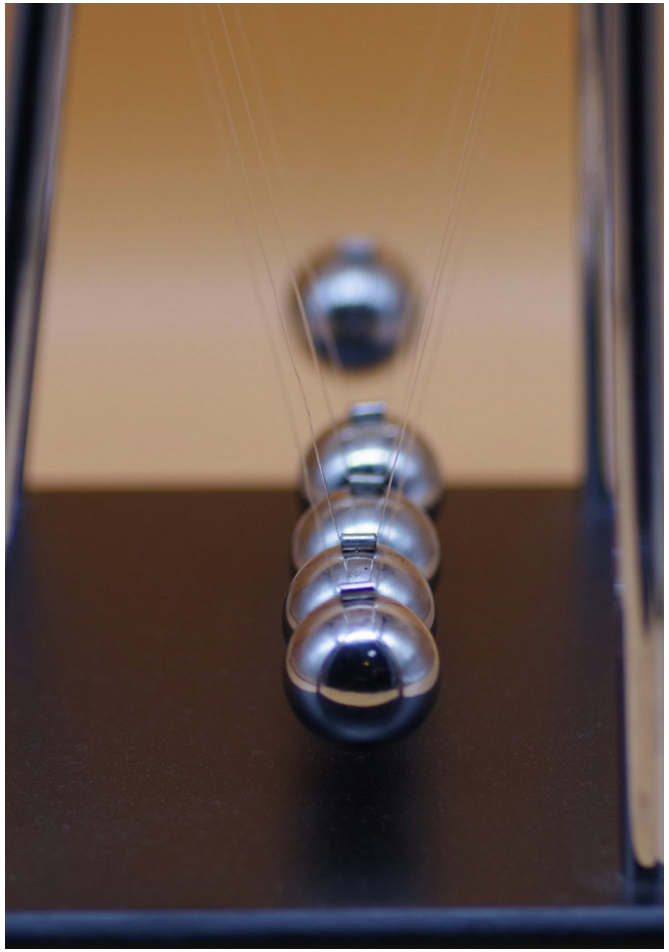
Delivery Capital

- Your Track Record of Impact
- Showing Your Value
- Proof Over Potential

Delivery Capital

Your Track Record of **Impact**

- ✓ **The value you help deliver through your work**
  (e.g. cost savings, faster delivery, better decisions)
- ✓ Measured in **outcomes**, *NOT effort!*
- ✓ **Ask yourself:**
  What results are you known for?

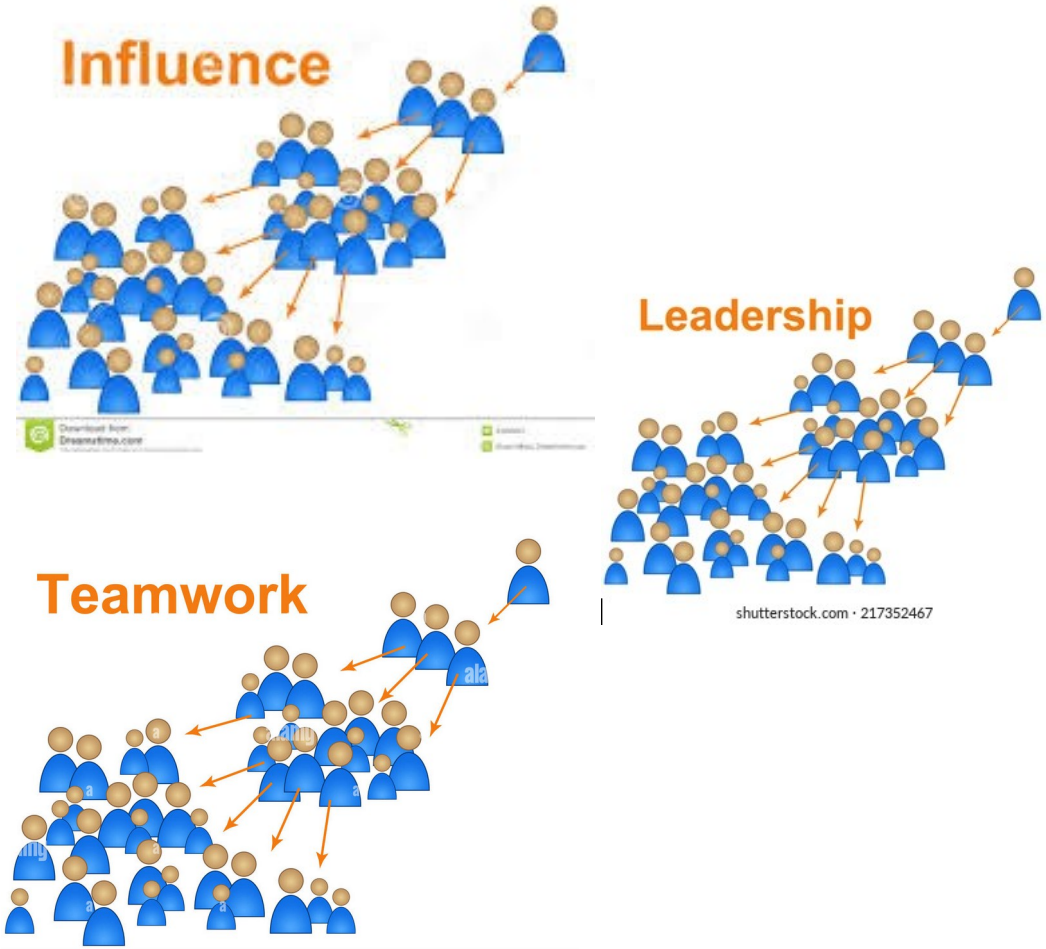


Influence Capital

- Leading Without Authority
- The Art of Stakeholder Confidence
- Trusted Advisor Energy

Influence Capital How You Shape Outcomes Through Othe

- ✓ **Your ability to lead, align, and influence stakeholders** (e.g. facilitation, negotiation, executive trust)
- ✓ **It's not about authority**—it's about trust and *clarity.*
- ✓ **Ask yourself:** Who listens when you speak?



IP Capital

- Make Your Knowledge Tangible
- Tools That Travel With You
- Productise Yourself

IP Capital

Assets That Outlive the Project

- ✓ **Reusable tools, frameworks, and methods you've created** *(e.g. templates, playbooks, models)*
- ✓ IP turns your **experience into leverage**
- ✓ **Ask yourself:** *What have you built that others now use?*

What IP Looks Like for a BA

- 📄 **Templates that save time**
- ⚙️ **Frameworks that drive clarity**
- 📚 **Playbooks that scale you**
- 🧠 **Visual tools that shape thinking**
- 🔧 **System changes that stick**
- 💡 **Deliverables with lasting value**

From Tactical to Trusted: A BA Transformation

- A Real-World Shift in BA Influence
- The Power of Capital in Action
- Elevating Beyond the Job Description

From Tactician to Trusted Advisor

📍 Situation

- Embedded in a large program in an ASX Top 15
- Seen as “just the BA” — not part of key decisions
- No prior BAS or Tax knowledge 🤫

📥 Task

- Gather requirements from Tax Directors and Teams
- Implement **Tax** Module within Workday ERP 🤯
- Test and validate the work of a Top 4

⚙️ Actions

- Gained **Domain Capital:** Deep-dived into BAS legislation on the ATO website
- Built **IP:** Created a structured decision framework for tax scenarios
- Focused on **Delivery:** Drove alignment between Finance & Tech, reduced rework, and clarified scope

🚀 Result

- Invited to Executive Steering Group to **Influence** further financial automation
- Shifted from note-taker to strategic contributor
- 6-month contract → 18 months ++

Building Your Capital Map

- Take Inventory of Your Assets
- Visualise Your Strengths and Gaps
- Your Career Growth Blueprint

Building Your Career Capital Map

Get clear on what makes you valuable



What's your **Domain**?

What's your **Delivery track record**?

Where do you have **Influence**?

What **IP** have you created or reused?

Exercise – Map Your Capital

🧭 Domain

Where do I have deep knowledge or system fluency?

- **Business Functions:** Finance, Marketing, Payroll etc
- **Industry:** Manufacturing, Healthcare, Banking etc.
- **System:** Salesforce, SAP, specialised systems etc.

🚀 Delivery

What value have I consistently helped deliver

- **Outcomes:** Faster processes, reduced costs, better decisions
- **Impact:** Project recovery, stakeholder clarity, simplified scope
- **Proof:** Success metrics, lessons learned, recurring results

🗣️ Influence

Where do I shape direction or unlock alignment?

- **Relationships:** Executive trust, cross-functional buy-in
- **Moments:** Leading workshops, reframing problems, driving clarity
- **Reputation:** Known for navigating complexity/bringing calm to chaos

📦 IP (Intellectual Property)

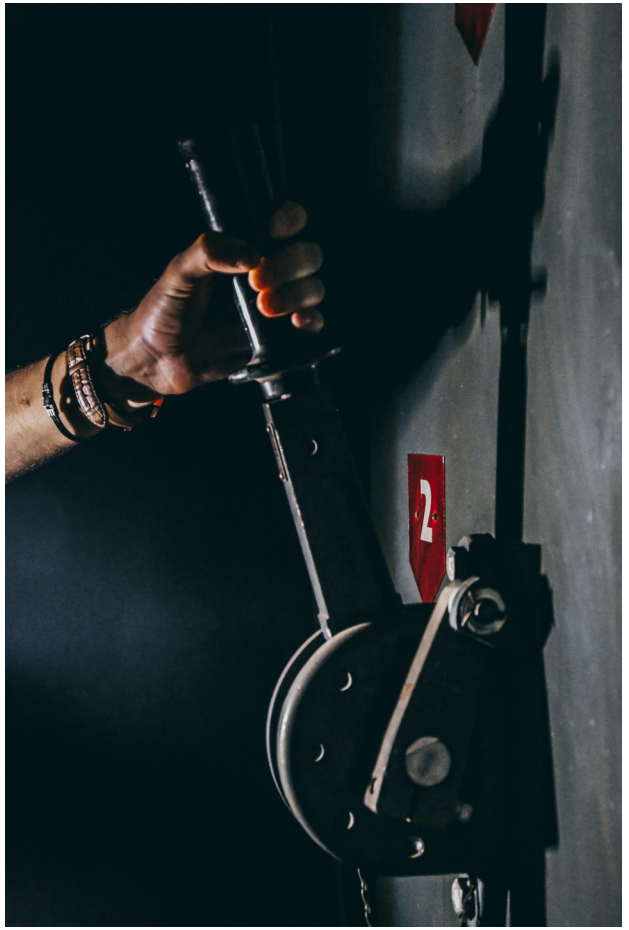
What tools, templates, or systems have I created or scaled?

- **Assets:** Templates, playbooks, process flows
- **Frameworks:** Prioritisation grids, decision models, delivery kits
- **Repeatables:** Anything you've reused or that others adopted

Look for Gaps & Leverage

What’s missing? What’s underused?

- Which area feels strongest?
- Which area is underdeveloped or invisible?
- What could be repackaged into IP?
- Where do you need more visibility?



Capital Map Example – Trevin

🧭 Domain

Where do I have deep knowledge or system fluency?

- **Business Functions:** Finance, Marketing, Payroll
- **Industry:** Infrastructure, Utilities, Financial Services
- **System:** ERP (Oracle, Workday, IFS), CRM (Dynamics 365, HubSpot), ITSM (ServiceNow, Atlassian, SysAid)

🗣️ Influence

Where do I shape direction or unlock alignment?

- **Relationships:** Executive trust, cross-functional buy-in
- **Moments:** Reframed problems to drive clarity and momentum
- **Reputation:** Shifted perception from “just the BA” to strategic advisor

🚀 Delivery

What value have I consistently helped deliver

- **Outcomes:** Simplified complexity into clear, actionable solutions
- **Impact:** Uplifted delivery squads and reduced rework
- **Proof:** Aligned tech outcomes with business

📦 IP (Intellectual Property)

What tools, templates, or systems have I created or scaled?

- **Assets:** IT Optimisation Scorecard (dxadvisory.com/score)
- **Frameworks:** Prioritisation grids, decision models, delivery kits
- **Repeatables:** Frameworks reused across clients and programs

Final Takeaways

- Your Growth Isn’t Accidental
- Capital is Built, Not Given
- Invest in What Matters

What’s Your Next Capital Move?

- Pick One Small Action—Start Building
- What Will You Build This Week?
- Career Capital Starts With One Step

Thank you!

Questions?